

A TILTED FIELD

Christopher James Ferguson

DEDICATION

I'd like to dedicate this book to William Spaniel for expanding my views on international relationships, internal relationships, and lines, as well as feral historian for introducing to a wide verity of books and ideas revolving around technology and the state, and how it effects man.

Thank you.

This is the rough draft of A TILTED FIELD, it is not intended to be the final piece of this book, and should not be treated as such.

A CHOICE THAT DOESN'T EXIST

MELDOA

Meldoa got into the car reading through the endless paperwork of profit margins and facility productivity sheets, shes tends to make a habit of going around checking up on each location to verify there reports, some of her sisters and brothers hate her for this but she adamant about the accuracy of her books, as well as protecting her fathers investments.

Her first stop was one of her brothers districts he was the one responsible for arms shipments both in and out of the city and by nature of the business, everything required a certain amount of extra

care when it came to ensuring everything was running smoothly. In fact one of the reasons father put this bother in charge of this operation was because he was reasonable, trustworthy and in good relations with Meldoa.

"Ah, nice seeing you again sister." Denna (Meldoa's bother) said as she stepped into his office, the rough oak floor and dusty interior making her nose tickle. "May I see your internal paperwork." She asked, never the one for pleasantries instead favoring bluntness one of the many reasons where she is today, however every blunt object has there edge.

"Yes, yes I already have them right here," Denna then plopped a mound of paper onto his desk. "I assume you also want a tour," He said wrapping up the paperwork with

a thick piece of linen thread,
Meldoa nodded her head.

The tour did not last long as it was only the warehouse, meeting locations would always be switched, and it would be odd for a family accountant to be at a place where supposedly nothing was supposed to be delivered, and the state mostly handled there own shipments so there was no need for that either.

"Anything else you'd like to see." He asked as they reached the entrance, there where only minor discrepancies many of which could be chocked up to errors, or changes in season. She shook her head, "no that will be all see you next quarter," she then left and returned to her car. "Hena's next," Meldoa said, her driver nodded, starting the car and putting it in gear.

Meldoa had 25 siblings many of which were still young and didn't command enough respect to be able to hold their own district, or business, only 11 had reached such a point, and she couldn't possibly do these 11 in a single day so she did it by priority, Denna was always the first due to the sensitive nature of the business, whilst everyone else usually got on top because of large discrepancies or recent events that compelled an early visit.

It wasn't long until she found herself at one of Hena's warehouses, a warehouse that was the location of a rather grueling crane accident that left a few people dead and one injured, at least that was what she remembered when the report got to her desk, in all honestly she didn't care much

for the people they where all apes anyways, what she did care about was the cargo listed on the manifest.

Expensive jewelry some of which where damaged beyond repair, one and a half tons of flour that was lost to the harbor, as well as a bunch of other miscellaneous products which where damaged.

She stepped into her sisters office, her child jumping off of a seat that was in the corner of the room. "Auntie!" She yelled, whilst Meldoa was by all means cold, she wasn't one to neglect a child in fact she has spent many hours caring for her sisters and brothers children effectively acting like a nanny however she did not posses any of her own.

She wasn't unable to do so, her

instrument was still apart of her and functioned as expected but unfortunately for her father lacked any such will to put that instrument to use, her sisters have speculated she's too self centered to think of such things, or to care but they had failed to consider that she just wasn't interested at the moment.

She picked up the child and brought her niece into her arms. "How are you doing Francis?" Meldoa asked, Meldoa had always been a hypocrite when it came to youth in the terms of small talk perhaps she knew more to motherhood then interacting properly with her other wolfkin. "I'm doing great, I learnt bigger words." Meldoa smiled, which if one had saw would probably see them drop dead from shock, "Learned, dear."

"Learned." The little pea respond her ears perking up to the ceiling, an easily excited little learner, "yes, dear, L-E-A-R-N with an E-D at the end."

"Ooohh."

"Now, dear where might I find your mother."

"Oh, she said she would be in the, ugghh, you know place with all the big boxs."

"The floor?" Meldoa asked.

"Yeah, yeah." Francis immediately responded. Meldoa held the child more firmly "Well lets go get here then." The child started giggling excited to be able to wander about with her aunt they walked for some time, until they came across a section which housed Hena, they both immediately locked eyes, the sister immediately

possessing an expression of annoyance.

"Let me guess, quarterly checkup," Meldoa nodded, and then her sister exhaled. "Come, I'll do the tour and then get you your documents, and I'll also assume you want to talk about the crane accident." Hena then turned around and Meldoa followed.

"Have you handled the reimbursements," Meldoa asked. "Yes, yes we've also taken care of procedure to ensure that it never happens again." Meldoa nodded albeit a little skeptically, her sister is well known to her to care about time more than about quality and these accidents have happened in the past because of this mentality. "May I ask what changes." Her sister looked back at her, Hena knew she couldn't blame

her for the suspicion.

"We've changed the ropes for chains, we also do inspections every week, to make sure that there properly fit for use." Hearing direct names to solutions put Meldoa at ease hopefully she finally reaching the point where she's recognizing speed is not always fast.

Hena then lead Meldoa through the warehouse things, could obviously be better but the most glaring issue was the sagging wood beam in the back corning, in fact such issue was starting to become noticeable on the outside of the warehouse as the weight of the create was starting to push out the brick wall but only slightly for now.

"And here's your paperwork."

Hena said placing the stack onto the table not even bothering to tie it. "Auntie, auntie, can I go over to your place." The little pea excitedly said, "that's all up to your mother dear," She then looked at Hena with pleading eyes, "fine do as you wish." Meldona, then grabbed the stack of paper placing it tightly underneath her arm, as she carried the little pea out of the out of the brick building, and into the car.

"Hello, miss Francis," the driver said with a smile, brightening up his day. "Hey," she responded as she found her seat, energetically bouncing her feet off of the end. It wasn't hard for Meldoa to find time for the children, all here responsibility's could be mostly dealt with in one place that being her manor, in fact

she rarely left such a place due to that fact, which invoked a constant prodding voice into her mind, that being one that belong to her father.

Meldona has been a virgin from birth, and has never married, instead paying more attention to her study's, which lead her to becoming the familys accountant, and now due to her role and her fathers increasing preface and reliance on her to ensure the smooth running of there businesses, would like to see her bring children into the family. In recent years his pestering had gone from somewhat tolerable to down right harassment, right to the point of luring her into blind dates and even recommending the injection of semen into her womb, all methods, and potential partners she firmly

rejected.

Although she knew he was coming out of a place of business and fatherly duty she was starting to run out of patience, and her annoyance was on a fast track to hostility, She pondered of what to do, she understood that she could just ignore him, as he had never disrespected his children's agency but she also just wanted him to stop and be quiet on the ordeal.

She thought a little longer until she decided that it would be a good idea to shelve it until she was alone and didn't have a child in tow. "I think we'll call it a day for now bring me to fathers house." Meldoa said beginning a comb through the documents before her. "I thought we where going to your house," Meldoa smiled. "We will dear, I just need to talk to

your grandfather first." Her eyes opened up, "oh, grandpa's house I thought we where going to someone else's." Francis always had trouble with remembering the significant of certain words, her mind, and sometimes it felt like she only took part of a sentence in at a time.

"My father is your grandfather," Meldoa immediately tried to teach, "your father is my grandfather... How does that work." Meldoa smiled at the excited little pea, "when I was born, I was born under your grandfather, which makes him my father, as I was born under him, and since your mother, which is my sister, was also born under him, when you where born made my father your grandfather." Meldoa went as slow she could letting the child digest what was being spoken.

"Oh." the pea said. "imagine it like a tree that's grown upside down, each branch is a separate person adding to the whole tree." The child's eyes practically popped out of her head. "Oh, so that means lisa is your sister too."

"Yes, dear."

"And Semosa is your brother, and Tela is your mother." She caught on quick, Meldoa thought to herself, happy over the fact that she was able to grasp something new about the world so quickly. "Yes, dear." Meldoa repeated. "Oh, that's why you guys all act weird around each other," Meldoa couldn't help but laugh a little, but what the child said isn't wrong from her perspective as to her they do act different when around each other especially with Meldoa as she is the favored child. "I wish mommy

would teach me more," the child spoke, Meldoa sorta nodded trying to remain natural in her expression.

The little pea was by no means neglected but, children require special attention always, and if that attention is not met it tends to harbor similar feelings of neglect. Meldoa knew it was for the most part her sisters fault for not being more attentive to the child's feelings and time. Her sister always had this knack for getting things done as quickly as possible in every aspect of her life.

It wasn't long before they found themselves at fathers manor, the white granite building towing over all the little shops and residences that laid beyond it's steel gates. Some would say it was an odd place for a manor, but this

residence had been built long ago when this was once field.

They pulled up to the front gate, one of the family's men coming to it, immediately recognizing the vehicle as he did, he opened the gate waving them through and the driver did as instructed, pulling up to the front of the building it's ornately carved door not even gaining a grain of attention from Meldoa who's become all too familiar with the sight, while Francis became infatuated with it's precise carvings upon crossing it each time.

They both entered into the man hall the child running about checking everything there was to see from the paintings to the walls, down to the tiny little ornaments on the railings, Meldoa

continued up the stairs whilst the child stared with glistening eyes at all these things, smiling as she did, and once she reached the top she gently called out Francis's name and she came running.

Meldoa understood the child wanted to see more, as she once did when she was with the litter, but she couldn't let her out of her sight, even in the safety of one of her family's buildings.

Francis hardly gets to see her uncle and only has saw him during family's gatherings and the occasional visit, he was nothing short of an enigma to her, he was quiet and had a look to him that told you he was a man who barely kept a quiet mind, with this the child coined her uncle the nickname strange old man, she was wise enough to never speak this with

anyone but herself.

The two then made it too his study, a place he spent much time in, a place where he's made plenty of decisions. They stepped through the double doors and where greeted my incense, Meldoa's father was sometimes anxious when it came to certain matters, he used incense and tea to help stave out rampant anxiety something that he has noted effects his thinking, something was obviously bothering his mind.

Meldoa and Francis then became seated, father only acknowledging there presence for a moment before writing down in that moment what he was thinking. "Welcome, Meldoa and I see you brought a little one." Meldoa nodded, "and I assume your here updateing me on alls the goings on." She nodded once more. "I've only attended to the major

concerns of this quarter, yours truly and my sister Hena,"

"Ah yes, Hena and I assume everything is alright with Denna."

"Yes, Denna business looks to be running well, I have yet to look over the documents but I see nothing different in my years overseeing him."

Father nodding his head pleased by the consistency and predictability that these two operate on, there good children and he wishes them well.

"However, Hena's has made an effort in improving the main warehouse on the port river."

The father widened his eyes a little, "you mean I didn't have to do anything."

"Not in this instance no, that being said there is a sagging beam,

and a pallet of cargo is currently pushing out the wall on the third floor, she made no comment and actively looked away when I brought my eyes to it."

Father exhaled, "just when I was getting hope... That's not something I can overlook, losing a warehouse especially now, will not be ideal, I'll hire a crew from Deshane, have them clean up another up and coming mess." Father then swore under his breath, making sure the child could not hear.

"Anything else." Meldoa shook her head, "those where the only two I could get to for today I intend to visit the rest in the following days." Father seemed to shift in his chair uneasily. "Make sure there quick, things are getting uncomfortable, with the Terina family." Meldoa cocked her eyebrow.

"Another war," father leaned forward a bit, thinking, "maybe," "I suppose then I should take my leave." Meldoa then proceeded to rise. "Come, Francis it's time to go to my residence." The child, jumped off the couch, and ran to the door waiting for Meldoa to open it.

"Meldoa, before you go any developments on a husband, I know a few men who are interested," at this moment Meldoa decided she had, had it with her fathers continued assault on her marriage status, but she wasn't going to take it out on him here, no, no, she's much too clever and much too willing for such an uncouth display. "I'm working on it father." Meldoa said as she hurried out the door with the little one in tow, in fact she already went over this plan long

ago.

Her and the little one both got into the car, as Meldoa went over the details of her plan in her head once more, to marry a fellow wolfkin would send the wrong message it would mean I'd be serious about becoming a wife and bearing children, and it would just ramp up my fathers assault however an ape makes the perfect threat, perfectly taboo to the point where people are disgusted by it, she thought to herself, while a mischievous grin began to take form, the perfect threat. All that she has to do is go about this carefully.

They soon arrived at Meldoa's manor, a large gated house just outside the city limits, it's land was small in comparison to some of the manors she had been to but

nonetheless to any common folk it was still vast, the child rushed inside with Meldoa right behind, both having separate reasons as to why there rushing ahead.

Meldoa tended to the child all night, ensure her time wasn't wasted, she learned, played, and ate until she had become tired. Meldoa decided it was best to wait until this moment, that way she wouldn't feel guilty doing her work, it was all going to run into the night anyways.

SIRCE

Sirce Woke up in his bed after another work week gone by, his muscles ached but they always did when he first woke. He slowly got up, enjoying the small respite he had this Sunday, when the wolfkin

would grant at the very least a single day off.

He then noticed the sweat on the sheets below him, his neighbors often talked to him about his screaming and wailing, it was three months now since it happened, he imaged he would've gotten over it by now, but the memory of the cable snapping from the crane and the resulting aftermath still shook him, at this point the only thing he wanted was his shoulder to return to how it was.

He stepped into his pantry taking a slice of meat off of a dried carcass, a gift he received from a local butcher after helping him pay off his debts to a gang, it's done him well these past few months. Since then took note of all the little things inside, compiling a list in his head of the goods he

will need to get on his trip out, he didn't have alot of money but a few cents can bring you along way with what he was shopping for.

He quickly left his apartment hoping to make this journey quick as it was his final day off and he was hoping to spend the rest of it in the park. He never really was a fan of his apartment it was cramped, dusty, and obviously need some love from the landlord, but he knew it wasn't going to get any better there besides, he'd rather look at the flowers.

He didn't necessarily like flowers in the way most people like them, as in the beauty they bestow, he liked them more that they reminded him of home, his mother is a florist whom saw some pretty big wiggged visitors and paid far more then what she asked for, and his

father was a carpenter hence Sirce's last name.

But even with all the financial backing from there affluent visitors they where few and far between, the little customers, the locals always made the bulk of there sales, and they where leaving there local town in droves as all the skilled labor went to the city's, and despite Sirce's skills in both his mothers and fathers trade, he's found himself in the gutter at a warehouse.

It wasn't hard to figure out why, why hire someone who has years of experience when you can hire an idiot off the street, tell him how to use a machine, and walk away as he produces an identical piece to that of an actual carpenter, and all the floral shops are small, local, and don't pay well either,

he was hoping to land a spot at Spectacle a world renowned flower garden and flower shop but that was in vain as wolfkin where only allowed to work there, in fact all the places with good pay only hired wolfkin.

In a way Sirce kinda wished he was stupid, because then at least he would feel like he was getting a good deal, but he knew that wouldn't be a good predicament either, he exhaled as he went into the local market, scanning the selves for what he needed.

Canned peas, onions, potatos, he wondered what he'd do if mom hadn't taught him how to cook, he then went to make his purchase. "Hey, Sirce." Sirce at this point was a regular, a rather helpful regular as he often was paid for odd jobs, fixing doors, dressers,

cabinets, point was the local apes knew who to go to when something beyond there scope happened.

"Hey, Neeva." Neeva wasn't a very tall man, malnourishment from what he heard had it's way with him in his youth, even despite the fact he's been stealing food from people here since he was little, and due to his experience's he was the one who helped Sirce the most upon coming here, especially when it came to avoiding trouble.

"Hey." Sirce replied, Neeva then looked at Sirce's shoulder, "is it still busted," Sirce nodded. "Wish we had a doctor." Sirce said, "Yeah, wish they let us into the collages, at least then we'd have less assholes." Sirce chuckled, "Say how was it back home?" Neeva asked, Sirce shrugged, "not too bad, the wolfkin where nice too."

"Really?" Neeva ask, sounding surprised, Sirce nodded, "yes, of course I don't know how it is now, it's probably a ghost town," Neeva nodded, "ghost town sounds preferable to all of this." He sorta exhaled.

"Sorry those fucking extortionists came today, I'm just feeling down again." Oh it's that time, Sirce thought, "it's alright we all need to let it out," Neeva smiled. "Maybe one day I can run in a field," Sirce shook his head, "land owner will shoot yeah," Neeva exhaled again, "fucking dammit you can't run away from it can yeah." Sirce nodded, "still better then here I guess," they both chuckled, "well, have a good one, Neeva." Neeva raised his hand, "and to you the same."

Sirce, then left and continued

back to his apartment, feeling a little homesick, but he had to stay here so that his mother and father wouldn't suffer his current fate, as in his mind the family couldn't suffer a worst fate then losing the greenhouse and workshop.

Once, Sirce put away his acquired goods, he then left for the park planning to enjoy the rest of his afternoon secretly collecting seeds, and sending them back to his mother.

The next day he quickly made himself something to eat as he knew he was going to be worked to the bone once again, and he could only imagine the extent his shoulder could bare, last time he went to work he had to get someone else to help him pick up some crates, luckily they where sympathetic enough to help.

And as he suffered throughout the day his wolfkin manager came to him. "Boss, want's to see you upstairs." The wolfkin spoke, Since then followed, am I being fired, he thought feeling a little anxious as he climbed the stairs, he then entered the room and notice a woman he hadn't recognized standing across from the boss, she turned around and look at him with an apprising glare.

"So this is the one you want to be ride of," the wolfkin woman said. His boss then leaned back in her chair, "yeah, he blew his shoulder out from the crane accident he's been slow ever since," the strange woman walked a little closure, "eh, he will do, Its'ven." He felt someone he hadn't notice grab his shoulder, "come on, follow me ape," Since had begun to

find the word more then distasteful in his time here it was used for everything in reference to his race, simplified, derogatory, with no sense or thought placed behind the people it described, like he isn't even something that's worth thinking about.

However, there where no objecting these commands if he was a little more proud and a little more stupid he could protest, but with how everyone acted in this room to each other he knew that these where all members of a family, so all he could just do was hope that whatever they where planning wasn't going to be his end.

He soon found himself being escorted to a car, a stack of papers laying on the seat across from him, the wolfkin Its'ven he

believed his name was called, getting in first finding the large man in the middle, the female wolfkin soon coming out of the warehouse finding her seat across from him, separated by Its'ven.

"Mr. Carpenter, my name is Meldoa Ackscene from here on out I will be your fiance," Sirce began to sweat, he new he wasn't important and that there was no reason for him to be held at such a level to be married into a family, unless he was meant to be played as some pawn in a game he didn't understand.

"And I will word this plainly, since you are an ape, I have no intention to actually marry you or bear your children, only in the event I require to I will do so in both prospects, however you are merely just to act like my fiance."

Sirce was at first understandably in shock, which eventually made it's way into an onset of depression, as he knew or at least felt like he knew, he was going to become a pet bird in a gilded cage with no will of his own, he only hoped however he'd be as valued as a pet pigeon.

That fact might be exciting for some whom posses certain proclivities, but to him it was a sentence worse then death, what was to become of his mother and father, money, freedom, was this going to be indefinite? All these questions swirled in his mind, still he kept a poker face.

He gently brought his glare to the woman who called herself Meldoa, "is there pay." "Sure, now that you say it I'll give you an allowance... Hmmm, yes ground

rules," Sirce, knew this was going to be the moment that was going to decide whether it was going to be a prison or a well looked after prison.

"You'll be given your own room where you may place your personal belongings, however you cannot damage that room, also you may not leave the premises without, my permission, or without me in company." A gilded cage just as he predicted, "my butler will lay down the rest of the ground rules, as well as teach you proper manners."

He exhaled to himself, he could jump out of the car now, it'll hurt but, He looked at the lock, it's pressed down they'd notice and catch on in an instant, then they continue to suspect every move he'd make would come with intent to escape, better to wait for a better

opportunity.

"Understood." The woman said, he then looked back at the woman, "I guess." She then gave him a less then delightful expression.

"Understood, mam," he then added, can't be passive aggressive with her. "Good."

After some time, they soon arrived at what he assumed was her manor, he quickly noted the large yard, hoping that they at least let him out there to enjoy himself once and awhile.

They then entered her complex, there where a few guards, but nothing to write home about, probably didn't need them all the way out here, Since thought, however nothing about the place eased him, he was alone with no one to fight for him but himself, and

while many mistreatment's by wolfkin where mostly verbal, there where plenty who preferred violence.

The butler then came down from the second story. "Is, this your, "**husband**," milady." Meldoa nodded, the butler gave him an apprising look, but it was less assigning value to a pet, and more determining the usefulness of a person, "hmm, quite young, say I heard you worked in a warehouse." The butler said as he stood in front of him. "Yes," he stroked his well groomed beard. "Good, I could use the help."

There was then a period of silence, Meldoa locking eyes with the butler, "milady, we've finished up early for today in terms of menial tasks, may I show him his courtiers, and hand him his uniform

and let him rest up." Meldoa nodded, "I do not see a reason not to."

"You may follow me then, oh and what might your name be." "Sirce." The butler nodded. "It's a pleasure to make your acquaintance then, Sirce, mine is Noventon." The butler then quickly changed his direction to one of the lower wings of the manor, Sirce in tow.

While, Sirce was still concerned by those that surrounded him in this place, he was beginning to like the butler even though he obviously share some sentiments with the other wolfkin, he was nether hostile, or demanding, it felt weird to Sirce, at this point in time, to be treated with some semblance of respect by a wolfkin.

The butler then approached a

door, and opened it revealing the small interior, with a single bed pressed against the wall, "this will be your quarters from now on," Sirce nodded as he continued inside, well at least it's cleaner than my apartment, he thought.

"I'll let you familiarize yourself with your quarters, I'll come back to pick you up for supper." Sirce turned around nodding, the door then closing behind him, he exhaled as he sat on the bed, he knows there some people that would not, complain about this predicament but that's just because they have nothing to lose, and Sirce now has to think about how all those things might change.

NOVENTON

The butler continued into

Meldoa's room, the butler ashamed of the mess she has created, a giant mess that he isn't going to hear the end of especially from her father, but he never imagined she would actually do it, indeed he has listened to her rambles countless time of her desires to rid her fathers worry's that she will not come into possession of a child.

But to actually do it, has her father actually driven her mad. He knocked on the door, "who is it," Meldoa said through the door. "Nove'," "Come in." He continued in, Meldoa sitting at her desk seeming happy with herself.

Nove' knows she won't listen to reason, at least not to the reasons that first come to mind for him, indeed Nove' has learned to think differently about the apes having been forced to work with them in

these environments for so long and while he still holds some prejudices, by and large he mostly consider's them somewhat equal, a rarity now days.

"milady, I think it would be wise to reconsider what you've done," she exhaled, "you sound like my father," the butler pinched his brow, "milady, there are plenty of wolfkin out there who would dream of this moment, why this poor sod." She looked up at him, "because then father would be begging for a child," she configured her hand into the likeness of a gun, "it's supposed to be a threat, something to scare him with." The butler sighed, "you do realize many would consider this degenerate behavior," she chuckled, "and what throw out one of the people he relies on to keep this ship running."

At this point the butler was done arguing, he knew he lost the minute she took a different moral stance than him, that moral stance being to shut her father up at all cost's. "Children," the butler muttered.

"Well, that is all for today, tomorrow I will put him to work, and we'll see what I make of him," She nodded, "hopefully he's useful," she said with a smile, knowing full well that her plan was beginning to come to form, now all that was left for Meldoa to do was to order a pair of engagement rings and make her threat official.

SIRCE

Sirce awoke, feeling grateful for the bed, but spiteful of the prison, he wasn't sure how long

this whole husband thing was going to last for all he knew he would have to act like this indefinitely, he exhaled, he hoped by then he could form at the very least an attempt to escape.

He slowly got up, putting on his uniform, a simple dress shirt, covered by a black jacket with the family crest worn as a necklace. He continued out into the main hall where the butler had told him to meet him in the morning during breakfast, Noventon he believed his name was, he was still getting used to all the names, especially of those belonging to the entirely wolfkin staff, which he knew was small from listening to the banter of some wealthy people, a conversation that took place when he was just a child.

Sirce exhaled as he walked the

halls to the entrance, which was only a short walk to the quarters of the workers and servants, then coming across, Nove' who was dusting some of the railings despite them almost looking spotless. "Ah, Sirce glad to see I did not need to wake you," Sirce nodded, still feeling a little groggy as now his entire sleep schedule had changed, although he couldn't complain as it had changed to be more in favor with his personal health.

"Now, if you'll follow me we are going to be cleaning the masters quarters, as well as the other servants rooms, and if the load comes we'll do that also," Sirce nodded, despite not knowing what, "the load," meant but he figured he'd find out soon enough.

"Alright, let's not waste time

we only have so many hours to clean." Sirce followed the butler down the hall into a little room that hoarded all sorts of cleaning supplies and equipment, "grab a cart Sirce, we'll start with the master's chambers." Sirce nodded, grabbing one of the carts, Sirce following him to a small electric elevator that appeared to be hidden in the wall.

"You'll be using this to fairy things around quite a bit so don't be afraid to make good use of it, also the weight limit is 500 pounds, don't forget that," Sirce immediately understood what the man was insinuating. They then continued up the stairs up to the third floor, and taking the cart out of the elevator then continuing down the hall into the master's chambers.

"Seems she took her paper work to bed, explains why she looked like she was in such a sorry state," Nove' stated, as he made the bed all while Sirce was walking around the room dusting. Sirce was somewhat familiar with home care at least familiar enough to the point where he knew what would make you do it again.

"Ugh, sir," Sirce said, pulling up a piece of undergarment from under a dresser, "Oh, throw it in the bin, we'll put it with the rest of madams laundry." Sirce nodded, doing as he was told, "I'd imagine she'd be more put together," Sirce commented as he went back to brushing, "I ugh," he then stumbled on his words once he realized what he just said, "we'd all like to be, to be honest I hated serving her sisters and brothers more." Sirce

exhaled and chuckled a little, feeling comfortable in the fact that he can lower his guard.

"Is that so," Sirce said with quite a bit of curiosity. "Oh, indeed this ones just focused on her work the others though are mischievous trolls." Sirce looked at the butler for a moment, "now when I was young I could keep up with them but now I'm old and gray and can't stand the nuisance, and this is why I prefer working for the madams father, and the madam herself." Sirce nodded, " I assume it's that they treat things more seriously." The butler nodded, "but I fear Meldoa might treat certain serious things with some childishness, like." He quickly stopped his tongue, "I believe it wise to stop talking before I say something I don't mean," Sirce

nodded his head, carious but understanding to why the old butler stopped, he too also needed to be careful of such things.

The two then finished cleaning the madams chambers, not without some more surprises from Sirce, whom found more woman's cloths as well as some bread that was logged between the wall and the leg of the nightstand, mold covered as one might imagin. "I keep telling her not to bring food into the chambers," Nove' said, speaking like an adult disappointed in there child.

They then walked past a pair of glass double doors, Sirce feeling the familiar warmth caressing his skin, he immediately stopped and looked out into it seeing nothing but weeds suffocating the many flowers, herbs, and other plants

meant to be growing in there place, although Sirce, never really thought the plants as weeds they are just plants at the end of the day, "does anybody take care of it." Sirce asked, the butler walked back to Sirce looking into the greenhouse, "supposedly," Sirce looked at Nove', "we hire a gardener but I'm convinced he doesn't really do anything," Sirce cocked his brow "probably should fire him," the butler nodded, "indeed, indeed, but that is not my decision to make, and right now we have no one to replace him."

A horn then sounded off towards the back of the manor, "oh, thank goodness the load here's, come Sirce." Sirce exhaled, disappointed he didn't get to at the very least do something that he was familiar with, but he knew if he did so when

on the clock, he was sure to attract the ire of those that reside here.

They then reached the small loading dock that was just behind the manor, a loading dock which provided quick access to the pantry. The butler quickly found a seat on a crate, "after you Sirce, I'm getting too old," Sirce nodded understanding, but still disappointed that he now has to do this with less help.

The truck then pulled into the loading dock the step to the bed of the truck looking a little banged up, "oh no," the butler said, seeming familiar with the truck, it then stopped, and then came back slamming into the concrete dock. The butler closed his eyes, and exhaled, a few men some are then came out of the truck, some of them

looking tense, with one having what some might say a stupid look on his face. "Hey guys, what this thing doing here." Sirce then understood the need for extra air that the butler took, to be considered a thing by a wolfkin, whom obviously has intellect of a child whom was dropped on it's head would drive anyone to violence.

Sirce then began unloading the truck, with the others, who seemed to have had there fill today, whilst the idiot was over near the butler talking to him, the butler having a difficult time engaging in the conversation, a few minutes then passed, and they had reached some of the heavier boxes that where placed farther into the truck, Sirce was quick to grab one, expecting nothing of it until his arm reminded him of what had been

done to it.

He fell to the ground, dropping the crate as a sudden pain came from his shoulder, he quickly laid on his good shoulder, grasping onto the one in pain as saliva filled his mouth, as he heard some laugh around him.

The butler was very familiar with pain, he was old after all, and he had a good idea of what Sirce was experiencing. "Sirce," he said staring at the poor ape, lying on the ground waiting for the pain to subside, he slowly turned to face him.

"Would you head to the greenhouse I think you wanted to do something in there," the only thing that the butler could do at the vary moment is give Sirce, some light work, although the butler

knew that what he really needed was plenty of rest, and a doctor, but he knew those where tall orders when referring to an ape, so indeed the only thing he could do was go light on the poor lad.

The butler then quickly made himself useful, despite his back pain, at least it got him away from the idiot, and after thirty minutes the load was brought off the truck, the old man exhaled as he looked at the three pallets of stuff all cobbled together he had hopped that, Sirce would be able for this part but knowing his condition he didn't want to put farther stress on it, he then thought for a moment and supposed he could see if one of the woman or men where willing to conduct more dutys, either that or he will be doing it by himself again.

He came down the hall, the one that connected to the greenhouse, looking and hoping to see if Sirce was alright, what he found was pretty much half of the greenhouse floor covered with dirt, and what he hoped where weeds all over the floor, he continued in straying away from the dirt, trying to keep his shoes clean, and to prevent the rage of the individual who was in charge of keeping the floors clean today, he walked throughout the greenhouse a bit until he found Sirce, sitting on a crate packing up some seeds, in paper whilst holding his shoulder.

"You do relize I sent you out here with the intention that you'd take it easy," Nove' said impressed by his work ethic, but still concerned for his health. "Sorry, just got carried away," Nove'

nodded. "How bad is the arm anyways," Sirce looked up at him, remaining kinda silent, "I can't fire you, not that I would all I could just do is give you less laborious work," Sirce then nodded, "sometimes, I can barely lift a tea cup other times it hurts to pick up anything with real weight." The butler was certain now he tore a muscle, his rotator cuff to be more precise. "I heard you got into an accident before you came here, care to elaborate," he scratched the back of his head, "a pallet of shit fell on it I got lucky," the butler paused. "I see, let's get you cleaned up then, and put some ice on it I'll put you in charge in finishing up what ever you where doing," Sirce nodded, and the butler went to find some help.

About an hour later, the butler

found his way into Meldoa's office leaving Sirce to wander around the manor, dusting and cleaning, "how is he doing," Meldoa said playing with the pen on her desk, as she stared at the papers that laid on it, "well miss Meldoa, I have no complaints only that he should see a doctor." She immediately scoffed at the idea, "I doubt that is worth it," "well it might be good to keep up appearances," she contemplated it for a moment, "nah, it isn't noticeable," well, he tried.

"Very well, but I do request that you go easy on him that arm is easily provoked into intense pain, also I'd rather not lose someone who seems to be doing rather well for himself, especially when it comes to gardening," Meldoa leaned forward, "gardening?" "Yes milady, gardening, I don't know much of it

myself but he seems confident in what he's doing, not much harm he can do anyways the bed was overrun with weeds." She paused, "indeed, well if he is any good we can finally get rid of that useless wolfkin," "indeed, madam." There was then a pause the butler wondering if he should press her once more into abandoning her objective and just making him a servant.

She then opened a drawer, pulling out two box, each containing engagement rings, "Nove', tomorrow I will intend to put my plans in motion," she looked at the butler with a mischievous smile, "I'm putting you in charge of insuring that we are served tomorrow," Nove' was now certain there was no talking her out of this so he decided to go for the

next best thing her father,
"understood, milady I will see to
it, now is that all." Meldoa then
opened one of the boxes, and
lifting up the ring contained
inside, "yes, I believe that is
all."

The butler then continued out,
skipping past his dutys that where
once at the forefront of his mind,
instead slipping into his private
room, picking up the telephone that
laid inside, "hello," a voice
sounded off from the other side,
Nove' immediately remembering who
it belong to, "hello, Dianna, ugh
may you be so kind as to route me
to Junias residence," "oh, yes,
right away Nove'." Nove', then
waited a few moments before he
heard Junias's voice on the other
line, "yes," "master, it is I Nove'
I wish to inform you of a

development at the manor," Nove' heard Meldoa's father lean forward, "your daughter has recently gotten into some mischief, and um is threatening to marry an ape whom was recently forced into service in the manor." He heard his master stand, "**WHAT!**", what indeed the butler thought to himself.

"I'm going down there this instant," oh, we can't be having that, "master, master please listen," there was then silence on the other end, until he heard his master sit, "continue, Nove'," Nove' exhaled, "sir, your daughter was beginning to become overwhelmed by your persistent request to bare child, that she has decided to act out in this manner," he then heard his master exhale powerfully over the phone, "I have been quite pushy haven't I," the butler nodded in

silent agreement. "I also recommend you don't run into this mess like a bull, your daughter is rather stubborn and I'm afraid she'd do something rash, plus she'd know it was me right away," he heard his master then readjust himself in his chair. "why are things like this, she's the only one who hasn't been a handful and now she goes on and does this," the butler smirked, "the quiet one does seem to be the most troublesomely intelligent,"

"you mean stupid," the butler wagged his finger despite no one being present, he enjoys talks like these allows him to get away with acts of judgment without getting so much as a glare,

"being intelligent doesn't mean one is socially," the butler heard a small chuckle,

"here, here to that, is that all,"

"I do believe so, sir."

"then farewell, and make sure she doesn't do anything more stupid until tomorrow," the butler then hung up, and brought his fingers to his temples, "children," he muttered, "always giving us two headaches," he then continued out, and searched for Sirce to tell him to get some rest, because tomorrow for him would be most harrowing.

THE NEXT DAY

SIRCE

Sirce awoke, and although his bed was comfortable, still he wished he was back in his apartment at least it would be a place where he felt safe, instead of being

surrounded by wolfkin strangers, he then got up, looking at his pocket watch, I wonder if I'm ever going to get my personal belongings from the apartment, he exhaled, probably not, Sirce then got up and got dressed, heading out to the dutys board to see where he was placed, he then quickly saw that it was in fact his day off, hmm that doesn't make any sense he thought, pondering if it was a mistake, he figured they'd be working him for at least a few consecutive days just to get him used to things.

He shrugged, all well, looks like it's the day off. "Sirce," he heard the butler from behind, Sirce quickly turned around and straightened himself, causing his back to tense up in pain as well as his shoulder. "Ow," he quickly yelped silently, "Meldoa, plans to

have lunch with you, and I've been tasked with preparing you an appropriate suit," oh, Sirce thought to himself.

"Lunch," Sirce said, "indeed, she uh, has her reasons," Sirce knew what the butler was referring he knew it because that was his only stated purpose, to be the puppet husband of a wolfkin woman, everything else like his new job, and his pay where probably only done to keep him in check under his own will.

"Are you ready, Sirce, uh, I mean sir," Sirce cringed at the mention of him being a sir, it's not like he earned it with the butler, which was an odd thing to think considering he's a wolfkin and he's an ape, "umm, you can keep calling me," the butler immediately shook his head, "I do prefer the

name Sirce in comparison to the title, but if I don't the madam will be greatly displeased with me," Sirce nodded. "Where to," the butler turned to the door, "after me, sir."

Sirce then followed the butler into a dressing room, "I'm also supposed to take your measurements for other wears," Sirce tilted his head, "can't I just use these," the butler shook his head, "Meldoa wouldn't marry someone of poor birth, unless there was a certain fantastical circumstance, plus if your husband was walking around wearing a servants dress many would think that she had used her power in unsavory ways," Sirce squinted his eyes at Nove'. "But she did," the butler stretched the measuring tape, "indeed. She. Did, but I recommend not bringing that up."

"Now disrobe your overcoat, I need to make sure my measurements are accurate," Sirce did as the butler said and the butler quickly began taking measurements, "your quite slim," said Nove' who was going around the waist, "yeah, my mom had to sew a good portion of my pants waistlines tighter so they would fit properly," the butler nodded, "hmm, I assume you came from a good upbringing then." "Yeah, I was an only child," the butler raised an eyebrow, "only," "yeah, my mom lost her ability to conceive after I was born, so I was given a lot of attention, and all the work," the butler chuckled, "I see."

The butler then stepped away, and opened a drawer, "and where did you learn to garden, from what I understand your last name is

Carpenter," Sirce nodded, "blame my mother, I still know how to work with wood, just gardening is kinda my forte," Nove', then took a prepared suit from drawer, bringing it to Sirce, "well sounds like your well rounded, I'm surprised you got stuck with warehouse work," Sirce shrugged, "wolfkin don't take kindly to me," Nove' then exhaled, as if remembering if he had forgotten something. "of course, you'd think they care more about money," Sirce laughed, "apparently not," the butler then gave Sirce his suit.

"Now then I'll leave the room, knock, and call my name when you are ready, and I'll share the rest of what is to come of today with you," Sirce nodded and Nove' left the room, Sirce then began to change, and thoughts began pouring

in he didn't think the work was bad, in fact it was quite easier on his body, and he partially enjoys his supervisor who seems to look at him as an equal, the pay was comparable to his last job too, however he would enjoy some time at his private residence obviously he still didn't like the fact he was forced here but he has soften to the prospect of it, still however being force to display himself as ones husband did not sit well with him especially since it's a wolfskin where he knows she'll subjugate him to her every whim, he remembered what she said when it came to both marrying and bearing, indeed the last thing he wanted for himself and any potential children, was to be held down and raped by some sick woman.

He then knocked on the door and

Nove' opened it. "ha, there, any bagging, no, Hmmm just around the cuffs, oh, nope too long at the skirt, the butler then took some pins out of his pocket and brought the overcoats waist up a bit." He then stood back, "that should work," he then exhaled, "are you her personal tailor," he stook his head, "good heavens no, I had to leave yesterday to get advice in the city, I do hope this holds up."

Sirce looked at him with pity, "does she just dumps things on you," the butler paused for a moment his eyes darting into the corner of his eyes, "usually no," he then leaned for inviting a whisper, Sirce accepted, "in all honestly she's better then her siblings, but this latest event has put me over the edge," Sirce stepped back, "oh," he then nodded,

"well then let's talk while we walk."

They then set down the halls to the dinning hall, "her father is supposed to be coming today, which is why she expedited this, she actually wanted to slowly trust you with your position, but he immediately went into talking about her finding husband last morning and it set her off," Sirce closed his eyes hoping that whatever the father does, he doesn't blame him, and that he mentions nothing of a child to this implosive bitch, opps, he can already here his mother a mile away.

"Now Sirce do you know anything of etiquette," he thought for a moment, "manors," "oh, um, hands off the table, speak when spoken too... Eat whats in front of you," the butler then exhaled, "well it's

clear you have an understanding, but you wont pass we will stick to introductions, if anything weird happens I will pass it off that you did not sleep well last night," Sirce nodded, and Nove' then opened the door, "we will continue with proper etiquette once this passes."

The two then continued in, Meldoa sitting at the other end of the table with a grin on her face, "good you've finally arrived, I apologize for the sort notice of all of this," Sirce felt that the line wasn't fully directed to him, and wish she was at least somewhat as sympathetic as the butler, Sirce quickly found his seat at the other end as it seemed like the most natural position, including that it was the farthest away from the witch that kidnapped him.

"Well then, Sirce do you mind if

you greet me," Sirce stared at her for a moment, "hello, Madam." Sirce was not in a good mood, and it poured through his words, and actions, indeed his body and mind spoke from the heart and he knew it, and he knew it would probably get him killed in this place.

"My, my your either trying your best to insult me, which is cute, or I seriously overestimated your intelligence," the butler sensed the rising hostility and that no party in the room was preventing it, he sensed that Meldoa wanted this for some reason, "I don't think the dockside has the qualities your looking for then."

The butler saw, Meldoa developed a short and subtle grin, she's treating this like an outing to a party, reading his emotions, evaluating his inner person, every

word an attempt at testing him, he exhaled, don't play ball with her Since you don't even know what this world is like, she'll tear you apart, just play dumb and smother your hate.

"C'mon can you blame a woman for wanting a rough and tough husband." Nove' felt the hate emanating off of Since the kinda hate that was uncomfortable to sit around, "if only that where true," she rested her hand on her chin.

"Very good, keep going like that you might end up with one of my garbage thrice removed relatives, hmm no that would be a waste, we won't keep it at one" she chuckled at the last word, and annoyingly fabricated chuckle meant to provoke, what are you judging Meldoa, Nove' thought almost whispering it to himself

subconsciously.

She then got up from her chair and walked over to Sirce, his eyebrows fully down his eyes hate filled eyes staring her down passionately, there's nothing like taking away a mans agency to make him like that, Meldoa sat on the table halfway, she wanted to provoke him knowing he'd be targeted, she wanted to see how he would react, how he would respond, gauge how much control she'd have to bring onto him in events like these, so far there's hostility but that's to be expected, whats important is that he knows where he is and whether he's actively controlling these emotions or not, so far he's doing rather well, not accounting for the banter of course but everyone needs a little sharp tongue to defended themselves and

he has it, he might not be as clever but he has it.

"your not vary good at self control Sirce arn't you," Nove' silently sighed, so that is what this is, he pondered while looking at the two, indeed Meldoa wanted a good appearance when it came to this, the threat had to feel real after all and she needed someone who was either subservient or knowledgeable enough to know what was to be done.

"What do you mean by that, I'm just sitting here, like is expected of me," Meldoa smiled, "expected indeed," yes he needs work, like every new comer would need, but he did a good job at diverting his rage and that was enough for her to consider him fully.

"Congratulations, you won," she

said putting herself in arms reach of the boiling man, she then put the case for the engagement ring on the table, looking at him for longer then a second, then leaning down to him remaining a sort distance from is face, "today you'll meet my father, and you'll act like my loving husband unless you want to end up in a river some where, it's all up to you of course," Meldoa was surprised Sirce's anger didn't turn to fear in that moment, she knew she had someone mentally strong, it made her ponder for a moment but it was just a vapid thought. She then brushed his cheek with the back of her hand, her skin sliding across his clean shaven cheek.

"Now let's eat Sirce, and when father comes play your part." She then signaled the rest of the staff

with a bell, and quickly food began pouring in, he will learn to like it here, Meldoa thought to herself as a plate was brought to her. == THE KINDLING OF HATE ENCAGED :autofit-option:

Sirce stood behind Meldoa whom sat in a chair, looking at her father who seemed to be taking everything well, but Sirce knew it was just a front and that this was in fact his worse nightmare, Sirce felt a little camaraderie in that, that he was not completely alone in his thoughts.

"Ha, so your my daughter's fiance, it's about time," he said with a giggle that betrayed him, Sirce looked down at Meldoa, seeing poisonous smile stretched from ear to ear, "indeed it is father indeed it is," I brought my hand out across my chest forming it in a cup

just like Nove' told him too, "my name is Sirce, Junias Ackscene," he nodded, "well then welcome to the family Sirce, I hope you treat my daughter well," Junias fought the words out of his mouth not that he necessarily hated Sirce, or wouldn't accept him as a person but at the fact the most stable of his daughters had actually done the unthinkable.

What the hell are you thinking, Junias wanted to shout but as with anything such a public outburst would not reflect kindly onto him, and now at this most delicate moment in the relationship between the Ternia family, he needs the outward appearance of the family to be strong. He looked up at Sirce, and decided perhaps he can make the unwilling participant crack under pressure. "So Meldoa, how did you

meet this man, not a lot of humans like to come visit here," he was right the only time apes actively came here was for an explicit purpose, like a diplomatic envoy, or because they where forced to by other means, this would challenge the first foundation of there 'love', how they met.

Meldoa smiled, "he was simply on an envoy trip, made a good first impression, and we exchanged a few letters, and we eventually decided it was a good time to do so."

Junias leaned forward, it was not hard to tell that he was thinking deeply Sirce was growing nervous as he thought about what it'd mean if he got confirmation, that there relationship was a false one, what would she do.

Junias kept staring at the two, this is a waste of time I should

just accost her right here right now, he thought as he leaned back in his chair, "Sirce do you mind if you take a step out for right now," Sirce then looked at Meldoa, and she and he went out the door.

"Meldoa, my daughter, what the hell are you doing," she leaned back and crossed her legs, "oh whatever do you mean," she said sarcastically, "enough," her father put on a tone she knew would only spell trouble if she didn't respond properly, "I've force an ape to become my husband in order to stop you from pestering me." They both sat in silence, the father exhaled, "in what way was I pestering you," she looked at her father disapprovingly, "oh, I don't know the blind dates, the weird meet ups with members of the opposite sex, the talks about artificial

insemination," Junias pinched his brow, "Meldoa, I am looking out for you the family," Meldoa's face contorted, "oh really well how would you like if you where told, by your father, to have sex with some random girl you just met," Junias stared at the floor for a second. "Listen, I am... If your going to be come head of this family, I want you to at least to have child... I need to make sure that your legacy is preserved because the minute you enter my spot there will be people who will challenge your claim," she spoke slowly so that there would be no room more misinterpreted words, with him pausing every so often to collect his thoughts, Meldoa remained firmed in her expression of anger.

"Really that's what this is

about a lineage, I understand my responsibility's, but to be treated like this by my own father is disgusting," Junias felt a wound produce itself on his soul, "Meldoa, I," Meldoa gripped the chair, "I hoped, you'd at least respect my agency and my ability to determine when the time was right, and whom was deserving enough to receive that right," her father then looked off to the side of the room, feeling a coming onset of guilt, "but clearly that's not the fucking case," Junias remained silent, perhaps I have made an error, he thought to himself, perhaps I have been too hasty.

"I'm sorry," Meldoa scoffed, "he will stay in my midst for the time being," Junias picked up his head, "Meldoa" she then brought her hand onto her chin, "I have no

reason to trust that you won't continue your assault, he will stay, and if you continue your actions I will bear his child."

Junias understood all the implications of this, how this would send shock waves through the wolfkin population, how the daughter of a wolfkin elite, produce a mixed child, Junias shook at what could happen to the family if he kept her in the fold and what it would mean losing her.

If she disguised as an elite it would seem like the marriage was completely political, he could arrange a few shell companies to be made, do some fake exports and imports that are favorable, as long as no child was born people would scoff but they would understand, "your supposed to make my life easier you know," she folded her

arms, "you to," he closed his eyes, he knew he was in no position to decline this either this is her house and these are her rules.

"I'll support you in this endeavor, and I'll stop harassing you, just don't conceive a child." She smiled, "thank you for coming to an understanding," he nodded exhaling, "anyways lets finally get back to talks about everyone else's financial situations," Junias crossed his fingers hoping that the rest of his sons and daughter have decided to be kind to him this year.